

As I Was Saying **BOB INGRAM** SPORTS EDITOR

More Outside Talent Needed

ANDY COHEN'S U.T. El Paso Miners finished their baseball season with a break-even mark (18-18). If that was their record in Western Athletic Conference competition, it would be a good one for an expansion team. But since it includes three losses each to two WAC baseball powers, Arizona and Arizona State, that's not promising for UTEP's conference debut in baseball next spring.

To be competitive in the conference, the Miners are going to have to get more pitching, more hitting and more fielding stars.

And while other sports at the college are recruiting more local high school athletes than in the past, baseball can't continue to depend almost altogether on El Paso products and be competitive in the WAC. Cohen agrees that more scholarships are needed and more recruiting is needed in other areas than El Paso. And he says George McCarty, the U.T. El Paso athletic director, is going to do all he can to up the grade of UTEP baseball.